

league, club

International League

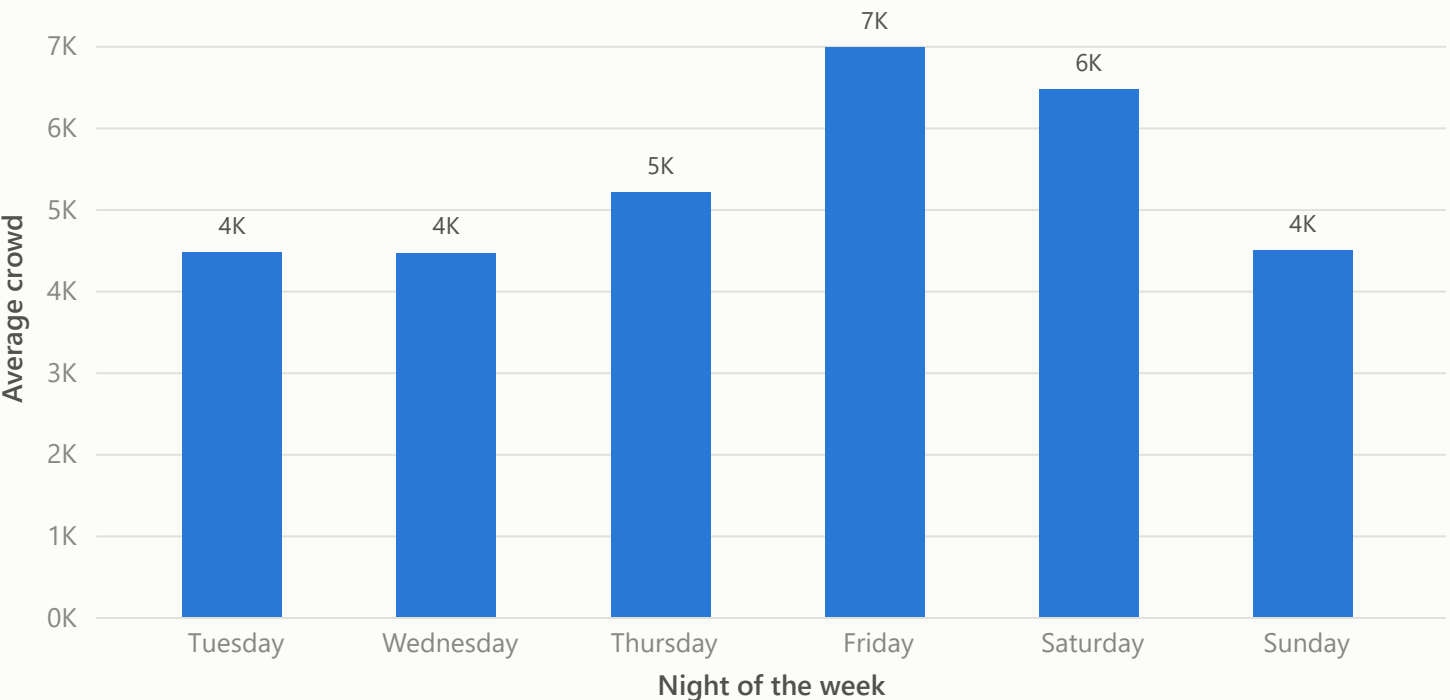
- ☐ Buffalo Bisons
- ☒ Charlotte Knights
- ☐ Columbus Clippers
- ☐ Durham Bulls
- ☐ Gwinnett Stripers
- ☐ Indianapolis Indians
- ☐ Iowa Cubs
- ☐ Jacksonville Jumbo Shrimp
- ☐ Lehigh Valley IronPigs
- ☐ Louisville Bats
- ☐ Memphis Redbirds
- ☐ Nashville Sounds
- ☐ Norfolk Tides
- ☐ Omaha Storm Chasers
- ☐ Rochester Red Wings
- ☐ Scranton/Wilkes-Barre RailRiders
- ☐ St. Paul Saints
- ☐ Syracuse Mets
- ☐ Toledo Mud Hens
- ☐ Worcester Red Sox
- ☐ Pacific Coast League
- ☐ Albuquerque Isotopes
- ☐ El Paso Chihuahuas
- ☐ Las Vegas Aviators
- ☐ Oklahoma City Comets
- ☐ Reno Aces
- ☐ Round Rock Express
- ☐ Sacramento River Cats

What drives attendance before any promotion

Triple-A baseball, 2026 season · 1,889 home dates across 30 clubs

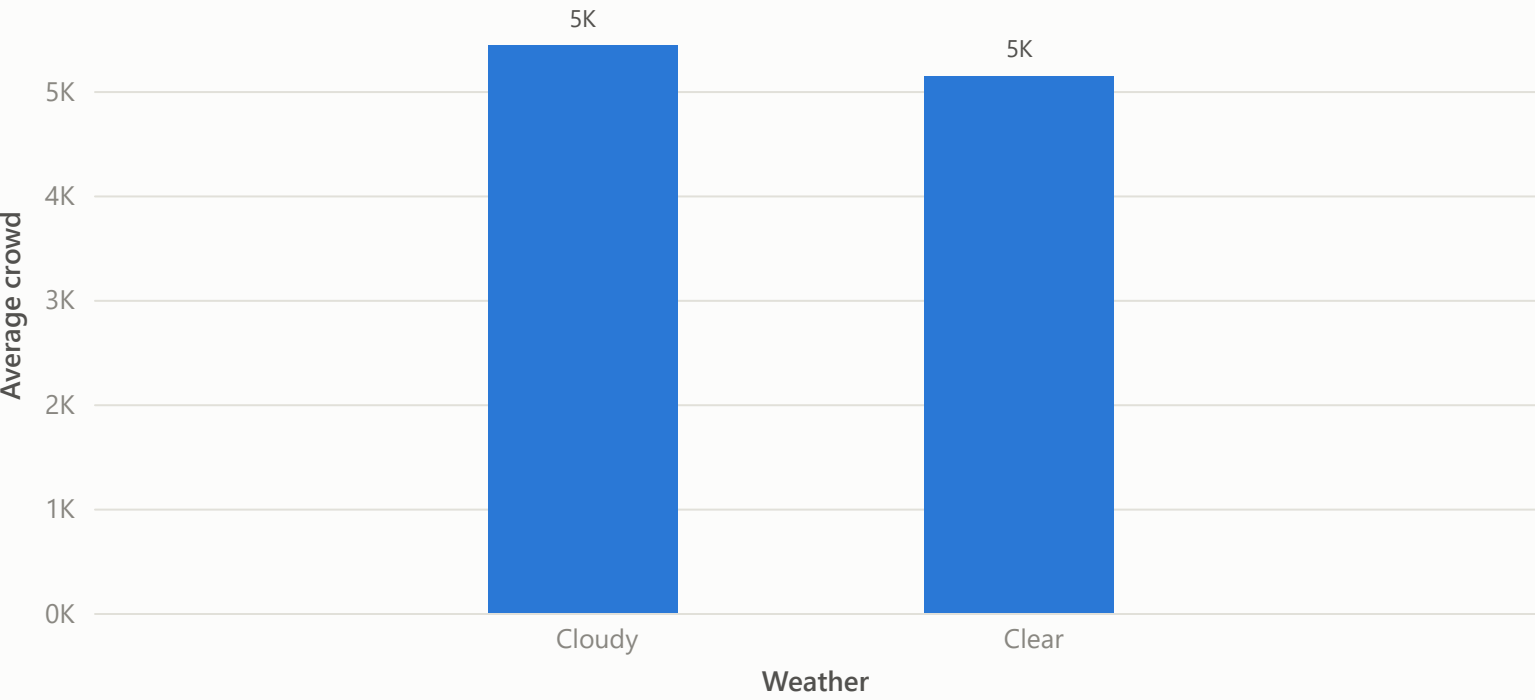
Weekend crowds run 45% larger than midweek

Mean crowd,all Triple-A home dates,2026



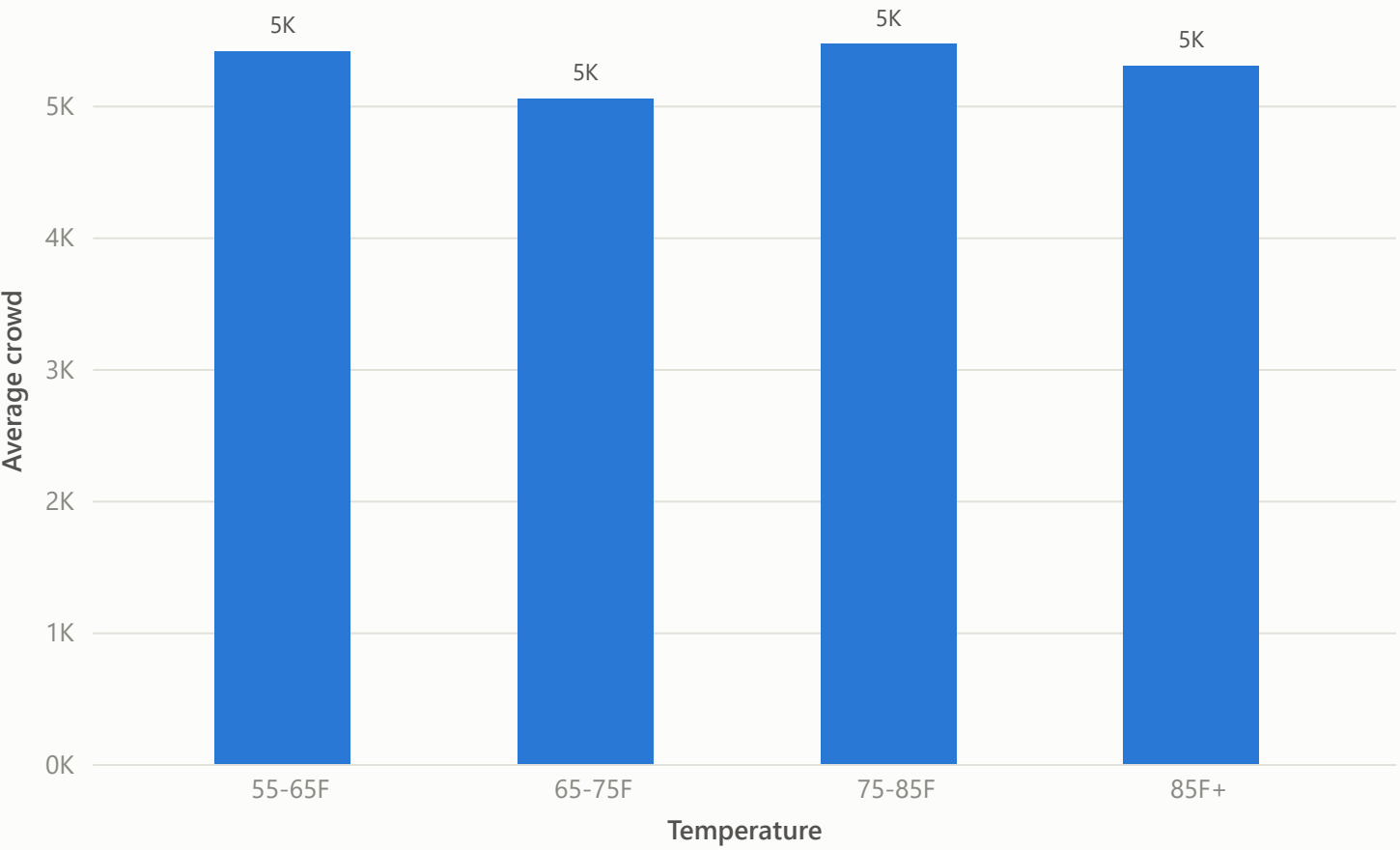
Weather barely moves attendance

Conditions recorded at the ballpark



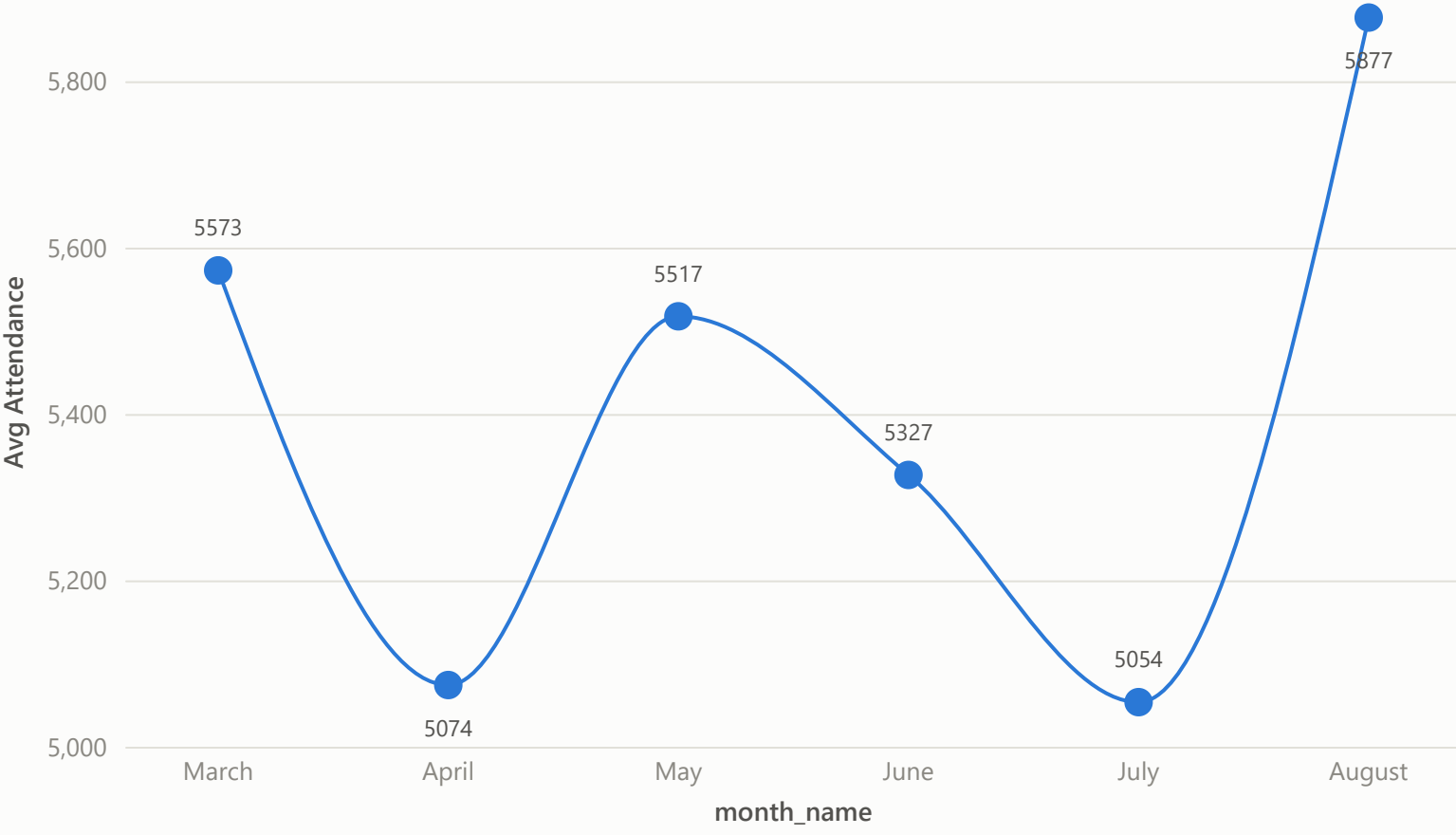
Attendance peaks at 75-85°F and falls off in the heat

Conditions recorded at the ballpark



Attendance across the season

Mean crowd by month



Do giveaways actually add anyone?

198 giveaways across the 17 clubs with complete promotional calendars

Giveaway Dates

198

Lift on giveaway dates

Effect vs Expected %

4.6

Extra fans each

Extra Fans per Giveaway

243

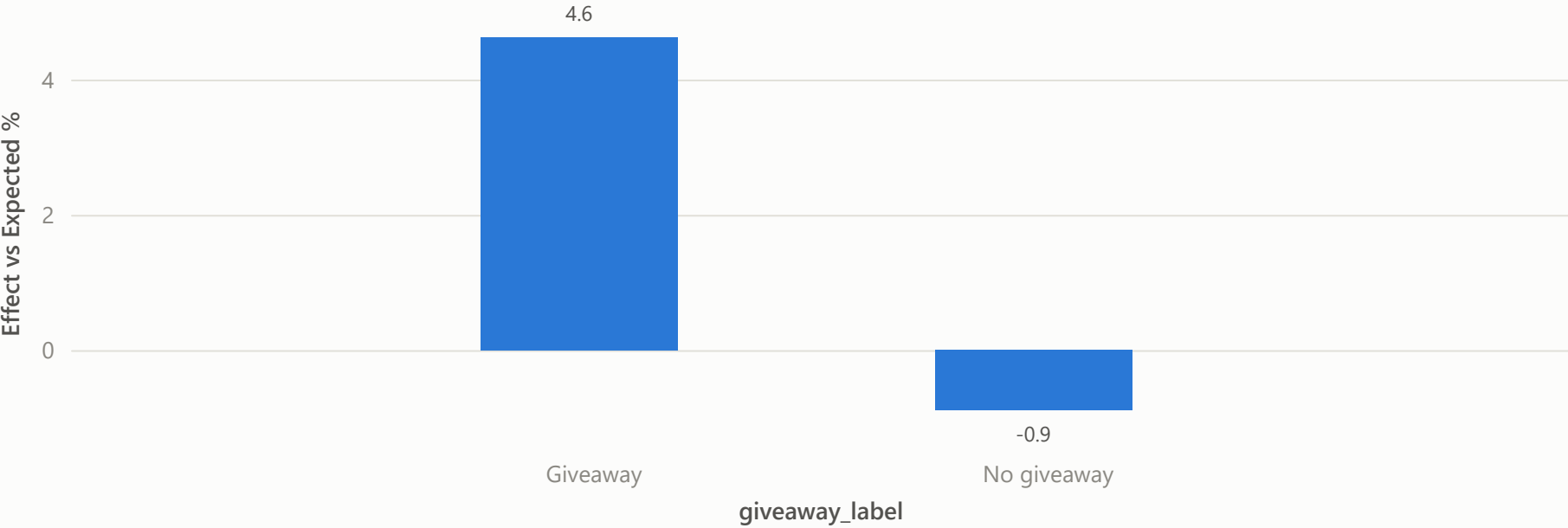
Baseline Crowd

Baseline Crowd

6.07K

Giveaway dates draw 4.6% above their own expectation

Effect vs Expected % and Min of home_dates by giveaway_label



Effect by night — and where it cannot be trusted

category	n	effect_pct	ci_low	ci_high	note
Sunday	23	1.01	-11.05	14.71	
Saturday	79	9.91	3.79	16.38	Control pool smaller than treated group - not validated
Friday	46	4.84	-4.98	15.67	
Thursday	14	-14.50	-21.21	-7.22	
Wednesday	24	-3.71	-12.22	5.63	
Tuesday	11	15.75	-4.50	40.29	

The findings

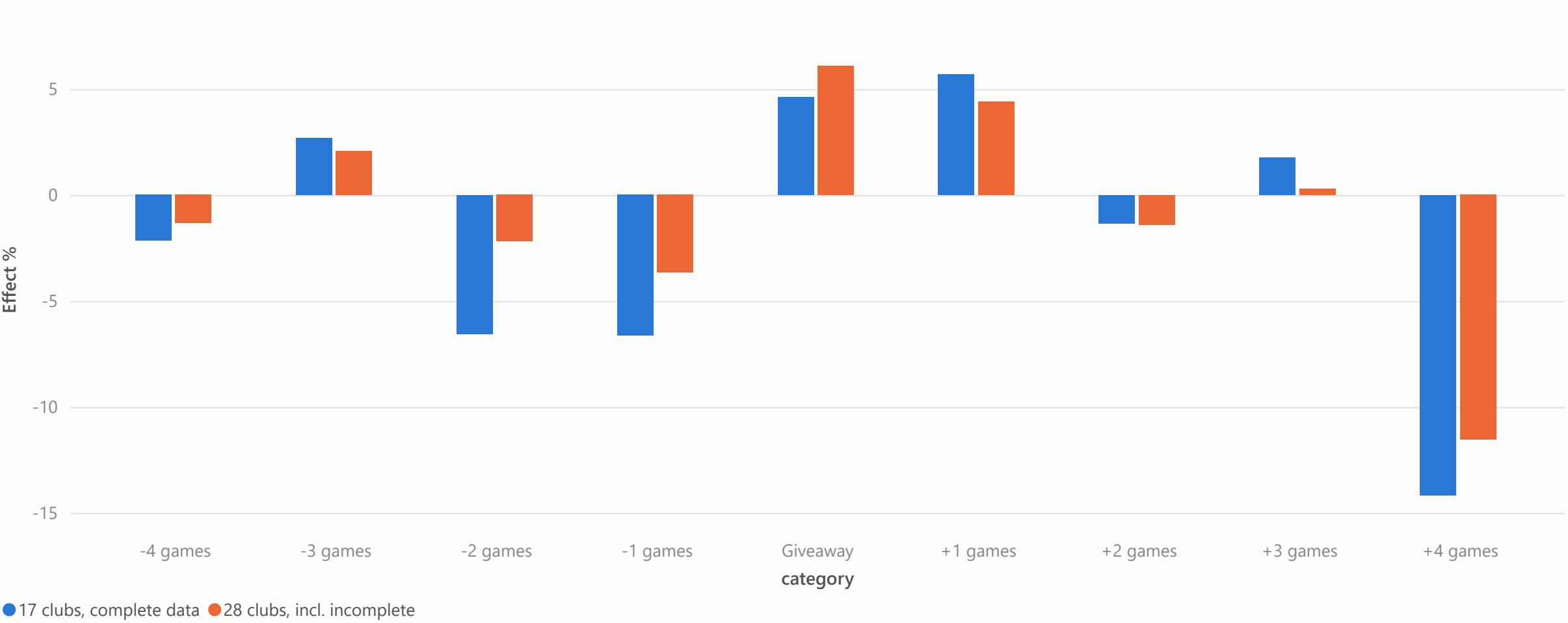
- Giveaways add roughly 5% to a Triple-A crowd — about 240 fans on a gate of 6,000. Far below how promotions are usually described.
- The estimate survives a placebo test: 400 fake giveaway sets matched on weekday produce a mean effect of –0.9%, against an observed +4.6%.
- Saturday shows the largest effect and is the one night that cannot be validated — 79 of 129 eligible Saturdays carried a giveaway, so the control group is smaller than the treated group.

Robustness: what survived and what didn't

The same estimate under two defensible samples, and why the displacement result was dropped

The day-before dip clears zero in one sample and not the other

Effect %, CI High, CI Low and Sum of n by category and scope



Bars show point estimates; 95% intervals are in the table below. Only the day-before dip in the complete-coverage sample clears zero — and it does not survive homestand fixed effects.

Clubs, and which ones the analysis can use

30 clubs · 17 with complete promotional data · headline results use those 17 only

Clubs in the league-season

30

With complete promo data

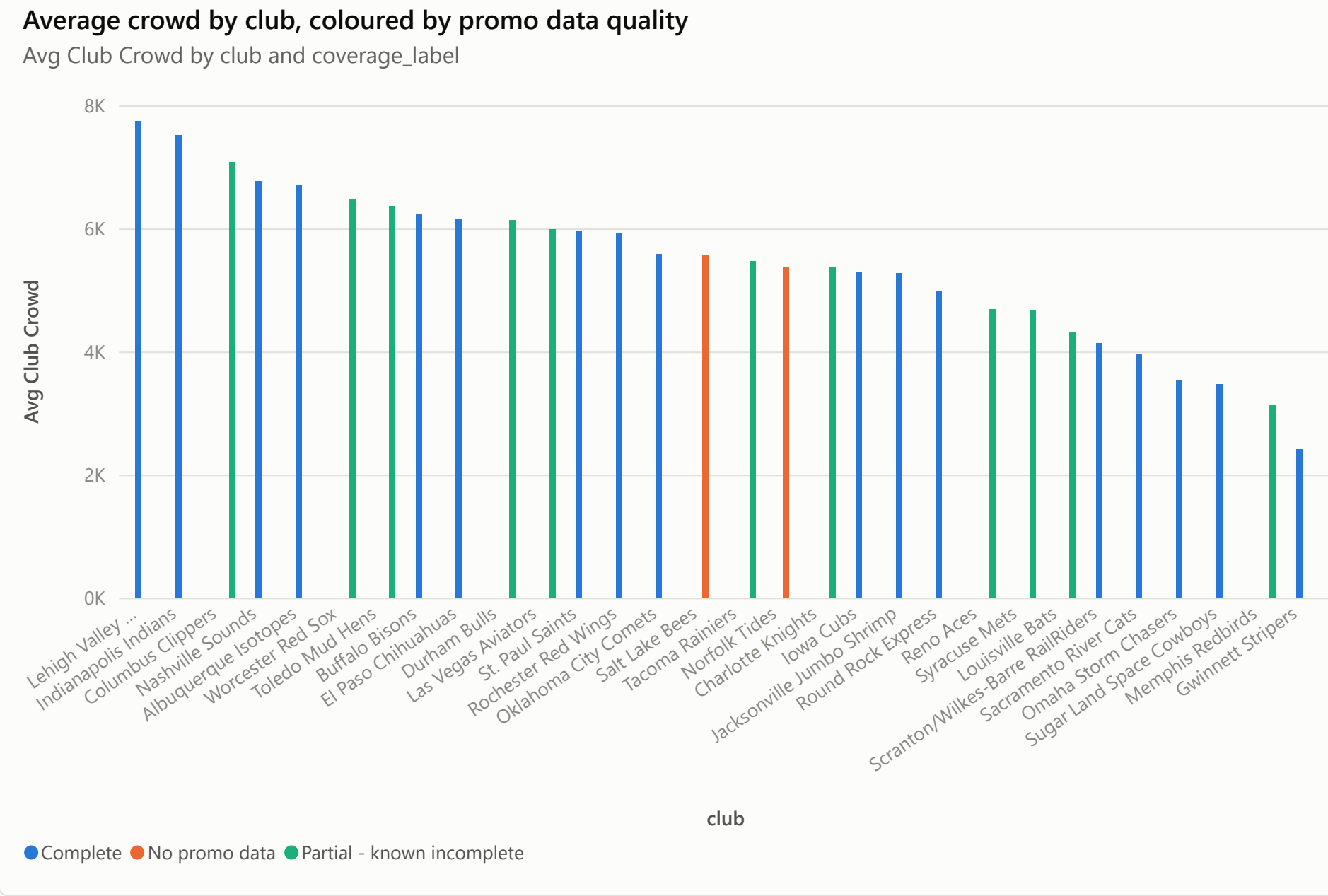
17

Gap, biggest to smallest club (×)

3.21

Average crowd range

2,409 – 7,740



Club detail

club	league	home_dates	Avg Club Crowd	giveaways	giveaway_rate	coverage_label
Albuquerque Isotopes	Pacific Coast League	62	6,703.00	15	24.19%	Complete
Buffalo Bisons	International League	58	6,245.00	8	13.79%	Complete
Charlotte Knights	International League	66	5,362.00	10	15.15%	Partial - known incomplete
Columbus Clippers	International League	58	7,074.00	2	3.45%	Partial - known incomplete
Durham Bulls	International League	67	6,142.00	1	1.49%	Partial - known incomplete
El Paso Chihuahuas	Pacific Coast League	63	6,150.00	4	6.35%	Complete
Gwinnett Strippers	International League	59	2,409.00	9	15.25%	Complete
Indianapolis Indians	International League	67	7,510.00	10	14.93%	Complete
Iowa Cubs	International League	64	5,292.00	2	3.13%	Complete
Jacksonville Jumbo Shrimp	International League	66	5,277.00	15	22.73%	Complete
Las Vegas Aviators	Pacific Coast League	69	5,984.00	6	8.70%	Partial - known incomplete
Lehigh Valley IronPigs	International League	65	7,740.00	26	40.00%	Complete
Louisville Bats	International League	65	4,314.00	2	3.08%	Partial - known incomplete
Total			5,409.07			

league

☐ International League☐ Pacific Coast League

coverage_label

☐ Complete☐ No promo data☐ Partial - known incomplete

Average crowds range from 2,409 (Gwinnett) to 7,740 (Lehigh Valley) — a 3.2x spread. Club identity is the single largest driver of attendance, which is why the model carries club fixed effects before any promotion is considered.

Giveaway counts are not comparable across clubs: 17 published a full season calendar, 11 did not and their totals are undercounts, and 2 published nothing dated. Headline results use the 17 only.

Do minor league giveaways create attendance, or just move it?			
Triple-A baseball, 2026 · 1,889 home dates · 312 verified giveaways · 30 clubs			
Giveaway lift	Extra fans per giveaway	Giveaways analysed	Clubs with complete promo data
4.6	243	198	17

Giveaways add roughly 5% to a Triple-A crowd — a few hundred fans on a gate of 6,000, far below how promotions are usually described.

The project set out to separate that lift from demand merely pulled forward from adjacent games. One season cannot answer that: giveaways cluster on Saturdays and homestands run Tuesday to Sunday, so "the day before a giveaway" is largely a synonym for "Friday". The apparent displacement effect does not survive homestand fixed effects. See Robustness.